

PRIMARY

Game Proposal

Team Details

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GitHub Repository:

<https://github.com/sahusaurya/primary>

Game Overview

PRIMARY is a stylized 2D action-puzzle platformer set in a world inspired by comic books and traditional print.

The entire world of PRIMARY is made using halftone dots, strong outlines, comic-style effects, and CMYK-inspired colours. At the beginning of the game, almost all colour and light have mysteriously disappeared. The player wakes up in a dark, nearly monochrome world and gradually discovers that the fundamental sources of colour and light have been scattered across it.

The player's main objective is to recover these lost CMYK Light Orbs and gradually restore colour to the world.

Each colour is more than just a collectible. Recovering a colour changes how the player moves, interacts with the environment, solves puzzles, and fights enemies.

The central idea of the game is simple:

Light changes the world.

Colour changes the player.

And restoring everything may come at a cost.

Core Gameplay Concept

The player begins with very limited abilities in a dark world where most objects and paths are inactive.

Early in the game, the player discovers the first Light Orb, such as Cyan.

Whenever a colour is activated, objects in the world made using that colour's halftone pattern become interactable. For example, Cyan platforms that previously appeared faded or inaccessible may become solid. Cyan switches can be activated, new paths can appear, and certain obstacles can be manipulated.

Every Light Orb also gives the player a unique gameplay property.

For example:

Cyan could make the player extremely slippery, allowing them to build momentum and slide through certain areas.

Magenta could provide a dash or burst movement ability.

Yellow could increase the player's jump height.

Black or Key could allow the player to interact with shadows, hidden platforms, or darker parts of the environment.

These abilities mean that gaining a colour does not simply unlock an area. It changes how the player approaches movement and puzzles.

As more colours are collected, the player will also need to combine their effects. A platforming section may require the player to first use Cyan to gain momentum and then use Yellow to jump across a large gap.

This creates a progression system where every new colour expands both the player's abilities and the complexity of the world.

Combat and Colour Interaction

Enemies in PRIMARY are also constructed using halftone colour patterns.

Instead of defeating enemies by repeatedly attacking them, the player must pay attention to their colour composition.

Enemies are defeated by using the appropriate complementary colour or colour interaction against them.

For example, if an enemy is primarily made of Yellow halftones, the player may need to attack it using the colour that counters Yellow.

Later enemies can contain combinations of colours, forcing the player to switch between abilities or attacks during combat.

This makes colour a central part of both the combat system and the puzzle system.

Boss fights can expand on the same concept. A boss may change its colour composition during the fight, forcing the player to continuously adapt and switch between different colour abilities.

Game Flow

The Dark World

The game begins in an almost completely dark and desaturated environment.

The player explores a small starting area with basic movement and very limited interaction with the world.

The environment immediately establishes the comic-book art style through halftone textures, strong outlines, comic-style effects, and exaggerated visual elements.

The player eventually discovers the first Light Orb, introducing the main mechanic of the game.

Recovering the Colours

Each major section of the game contains one of the missing Light Orbs.

Whenever the player obtains a new orb, it introduces:

A new colour into the world

A new player ability

New interactable objects

New enemy types

New puzzle mechanics

Previously explored areas may also contain paths that can only be accessed after unlocking later colours, encouraging exploration and backtracking.

Combining Colours

As the player obtains more Light Orbs, the puzzles become more complex.

Instead of relying on a single colour at a time, the player must begin combining different abilities.

For example, the player may use Cyan's slippery movement to gain speed and then switch to Yellow's enhanced jump to reach a distant platform.

Combat encounters can work in the same way, requiring the player to quickly recognise enemy colours and switch to the correct counter.

Restoring the World

Near the end of the game, the player finally obtains all of the missing colours.

For the first time, the environment begins to resemble a fully coloured comic-book world.

The player reaches the source of the darkness and prepares to restore light to the entire world.

This leads directly into the final narrative twist.

Narrative and Plot Twist

Throughout the game, the player is led to believe that collecting all of the Light Orbs will allow them to restore the world.

As the protagonist collects more colours, they become stronger and gain more abilities.

However, the player eventually discovers that the protagonist has not simply been carrying the Light Orbs.

They have been absorbing them.

The reason the world has not fully regained its colour is because the light is now trapped inside the protagonist.

To restore the world completely, all of the collected light must be released at once.

Doing this will destroy the protagonist.

The final sequence therefore becomes a deliberate sacrifice.

The player activates all of the colours one final time and releases them into the world.

For the first time in the game, the entire screen becomes fully coloured.

The world is restored.

The protagonist, however, disappears along with the light they were carrying.

The final scene shows the now fully coloured world continuing without them.

Theme Justification

Comic

The Comic theme forms the visual identity of PRIMARY.

The art style is heavily inspired by comic-book printing techniques, particularly halftone dot patterns and CMYK printing.

Environments, enemies, effects, and characters are all designed around this style.

The presentation can also include elements such as panel-style transitions, speech bubbles, comic sound effects like BAM, WHOOSH, and CRACK, impact frames during combat, printed-paper textures, and limited colour palettes.

The Comic theme is therefore not only part of the visual presentation. It is directly connected to the game's colour-based mechanics.

Light

Light is one of the central gameplay and narrative mechanics of PRIMARY.

The world begins without light and colour, and the player's main objective is to recover the missing Light Orbs.

Light determines which parts of the world can be interacted with, which objects become active, which abilities the player possesses, how enemies are defeated, and how the environment changes throughout the game.

As the player progresses, the world gradually transitions from dark and monochrome into a vibrant CMYK-inspired comic world.

The restoration of light is therefore visible throughout the entire game rather than only appearing as a story element.

Twist

The main Twist occurs at the end of the game.

The player spends the entire game believing that collecting all of the Light Orbs will allow them to save the world.

Instead, they discover that the protagonist has absorbed the light and that the world cannot be completely restored while they are still carrying it.

The protagonist must sacrifice themselves and release all of the collected Light Orbs to permanently restore colour to the world.

This changes the meaning of the player's progression.

The colours that continuously made the protagonist stronger eventually become the reason they must give themselves up.

Summary

PRIMARY is a comic-inspired 2D action-puzzle platformer where colour functions as light, movement, combat, and progression.

The use of CMYK colours and halftone printing connects the game's visual design directly to its mechanics.

The player gradually restores colour to the world while gaining new movement abilities, unlocking new environmental interactions, and learning how to defeat colour-based enemies.

The game incorporates all three required themes naturally.

Comic is represented through the halftone and CMYK visual identity of the world.

Light is represented through the missing Light Orbs and the gradual restoration of colour.

Twist is represented through the final revelation that restoring the world requires the protagonist to sacrifice themselves.